

NAVY 2020: STRONG AND CREDIBLE

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The Official Publication of The Philippine Navy

- NLC: Developing IT based Supply Management
- The Challenges of Naval Technical Training
- Personnel Division Marks New Milestone Thru PN Human Capital Strategy



114th Philippine Navy
Anniversary Issue 2012

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About the Cover

As a maritime archipelagic nation, it is essential for the Philippines to have a strong and credible naval force to respond to all forms of threats and face all the challenges that are prevalent in a country surrounded by waters and is made up of 7,100 islands. No one can deny that indeed, a strong and credible Navy is an imperative in realizing a progressive maritime country such as the Philippines. We need to boost the Navy's capability and capacity in order to enhance its strength and credibility and eventually support the nation's all-out efforts to become a progressive maritime country.

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From the Editor's Desk



No doubt, everybody in the Navy and everyone who supports a progressive maritime Philippines are craving for a strong and credible naval force by year 2020. This year's theme highlights this yearning which is an imperative for a progressive maritime Philippines.

It's really hard not to notice that the Sailors and Marines of the Philippine Navy find the need to become strong and credible vital not only for the Navy itself but for the entire Filipino nation as well. The events of the past year add to this need especially at the onset of the clear threats to our national security – global warming, environmental degradation, illegal fishing, smuggling, and territorial issues. More than ever, a fully mission capable Navy is essential especially for a maritime archipelagic country such as ours.

As we experience facing these threats and eventually adapting to overcome the challenges set upon us, there have nonetheless been lighter moments that the Navy can cherish. Our newly acquired frigate BRP Gregorio del Pilar, the Filipino-made BRP Tagbanua, and the freshly refurbished BO-105 Helicopter exemplify these moments and they add to our efforts towards achieving our vision. The next few months of this year will see additional acquisitions to further boost our capability and capacity upgrades as we begin to see more clearly that we are indeed well on our way towards our desire to become strong and credible.

Throughout our efforts for the past year towards our vision, we realize the significant role that the Navy plays in achieving a progressive maritime Philippines. We also realize that we alone can never be sufficient to realize our dream. We need the faith and support of the entire Filipino stakeholders to achieve our vision and strive for a progressive maritime Philippines. We need the entire Filipino nation to be one with us so that we can become strong and credible by year 2020.


OMAR L. TONSAY

COL PN(M)(GSC)

Director, Naval Public Affairs Office



Malacañan Palace

Manila

*My warmest greetings to the **Philippine Navy**, as you celebrate your **114th Anniversary**.*

This is a time to pay tribute to your patriotism, dedication, and excellence amidst the challenges that we have faced, the triumphs we have achieved, and the steadfastness required of us as we pursue the collective goal of national transformation. Indeed, this era of hope has thrown light on the many facets of nation-building that need our urgent action. Rest assured that your government is committed to the goal of developing our maritime capabilities so it may better complement the inherent courage and skills of our navymen, thus putting an end to the complacency that, for so long, has hindered the advancement of our defense institutions.

I also take this occasion to express my confidence in the men and women of the Philippine Navy, in their commitment to secure our seas and uphold our sovereignty. Your strength and bravery allow the rest of our people a chance to fulfill their own role in the task of rebuilding our nation. I take pride that you continue to serve with honor as our country begins to reap the fruits of reform.

Again, congratulations! Mabuhay ang Hukbong Dagat ng Pilipinas!


BENIGNO S. AQUINO III

Message



Republic of the Philippines Department of National Defense Office of the Secretary

Camp General Emilio Aguinaldo, Quezon City

I convey my warmest greetings to the officers, enlisted personnel and civilian employees of the Philippine Navy (PN) on the occasion of your 114th Anniversary!

It is with pride that I commend the leadership, the officers and the men and women of the Philippine Navy as it sails towards its vision: “By 2020, we shall be a strong and credible Navy that our maritime nation can be proud of.”

Today, we face ever-growing challenges that test our determination and commitment to the conduct of our duties and responsibilities. I enjoin everyone in the Philippine Navy to continue treading that straight and narrow path along the established idelas of good governance, transparency and accountability.

May I take this opportunity to express the gratitude of our people to the Philippine Navy for helping address national security concerns, conducting search and rescue missions, and undertaking various projects in support of the socio-economic development of the country. Your significant accomplishments have brought prestige and honor not only to the Armed Forces of the Philippines, but to the Department of National Defense as well.

Congratulations and keep up the good work!


VOLTAIRE T. GAZMIN
Secretary

Message



Chief of Staff Armed Forces of the Philippines Camp General Emilio Aguinaldo, Quezon City



In an archipelagic state like ours, the modern navy is called to assume multifarious roles: protector of our seas and their embedded natural resources; defender of our territorial integrity; partner of our people toward national development; and facilitator of cooperation among other stakeholders in securing regional peace and stability. Hence, we need a strong and credible Philippine Navy that shall excellently carry out these obligations.

Sa paggunita ninyo ngayon ng inyong ika-isandaan at labing apat na taong anibersaryo ng pagkakatatag, ipinagmamalaki ko ang di matatawarang ambag ninyo sa ating lipunan. Kayo ang nagpatuloy sa dakilang tradisyon ng mga Pilipino bilang marino at mandaragat. Ipinakita ninyo na ang ating Hukbong Dagat ay isang institusyong maaasahan sa oras man ng peligro o kapayapaan. Sa mga ipinakita ninyong serbisyong-bayan, naging kabahagi ang sandatahang Lakas ng Pilipinas sa buhay ng mga ordinaryong mamamayan.

As our country sails forth in the pages of history, we are challenged by manifold security issues. I enjoin you to remain committed to our national cause. Let our IPSP Bayanihan serve as important compass in the conduct of naval operations. Be constantly reminded that our greatest strength is derived from the strategic partnership we build with our own people.

Congratulations to all the officers, enlisted personnel, and civilian employees of the Philippine Navy. I wish you a merry and meaningful celebration of your 114th Founding Anniversary.

Mabuhay ang Hukbong Dagat ng Pilipinas!

Message

JESSIE D DELLOSA
GEN AFP



From the Helm Flag Officer in Command

Headquarters Philippine Navy Roxas Boulevard, Manila



On the occasion of our 114th Foundation Anniversary, my warmest greetings, sincerest gratitude, and congratulations to all Sailors, Marines, and Civilian Employees of the Philippine Navy!!!

I take great pride and honor in leading you again in celebrating another year filled with outstanding achievements. We manifested the past year our growing resolve at strengthening the Team Navy with everybody's steadfast commitment. Together, we brought to fore the urgent need for capacity-enhancement and capability-building to get us closer to becoming the strong, and equally important, credible Navy that we can ever be.

*Today, as we highlight where our Navy is and where it is headed, I urge everybody that we sustain and put more emphasis, like never before, on what kind of Navy we urgently need – the kind that our Maritime Nation truly deserves, a strong and credible Navy. In this year's anniversary theme: **"Strong and Credible Navy for a Progressive Maritime Philippines"**, we emphasize our advocacy of the imperatives for progress in our Maritime Nation.*

Clearly, our vision for the Navy is a work in progress. We have consistently believed it to be real and attainable. We are therefore eternally grateful to our National Leaders for their enduring commitment to the Navy, for believing in what we stand for, and for the trust and confidence bestowed upon us. We are inspired by their continuous support and appreciation of the Navy in our efforts at leveling-up and advancing our cause in serving our Maritime Nation and the Filipino people.

Indeed, it was a successful year for all of us and let us carry on!!!

Happy Anniversary!!! Mabuhay Tayong Lahat!!!


ALEXANDER P. PAMA
Vice Admiral AFP

A Conceptual Framework for a Naval Medicine Service Doctrine

MAJ JEFFREY ALAN G PIZARRO MC (PN)

The PN Sail Plan envisions a modernized naval organization that would be capable to address tasks and missions thrown in its way from ISO to TDO. The most important element of the PN is its manpower, the force that drives the organization. In order for the organization to achieve its goals, its personnel have to be in shape for them to be a fit and healthy force. That task, or specifically conserving the fighting strength of the sailor and marine is the main mission of the PN Medical Service. In that light, the PN Medical Service also has to grow and tailor its advancement to keep in pace with developments in the Navy as it modernizes. The following is a proposal on how the PN Medical Service can organizationally address the needs and demands of the PN in terms of modernizing and upgrading its doctrine.

Currently, the PN Medical Service is organized along existing type command subordinate organizations of the PN; medical services are however lumped in a general term that is, "shotgun" or broad in nature. Most of PN medical services are limited due to manpower and organizational restriction. Because of such, sometimes the right person is not able to deliver the right services required. Instead of simply following type command organization to provide

medical services, it is postulated that PN Medical Services be also organized along the lines of what type of medical care it can give. As of late, most of PN medical forces and their services are tailored for hospital medicine or medical care provided by medical treatment facilities (MTF's), to the detriment of forces of the line in the operational realm. Thus operational medicine or medical care provided in austere areas wherein higher levels of medical care are absent or inadequate is proposed to be developed. The Philippine Marine Corps (PMC) has its medical forces providing operational medicine instead of hospital medicine for the simple reason that the PMC has no MTF's, except for a dispensary at the main training base in Ternate, Cavite. The bulk of medical forces of the PMC thus are providing field medical support to the brigade down to platoon level. In the PN context, medical care afloat is primarily operational medicine, which can be further subdivided into aviation medicine, as exemplified by the Flight Surgeons supporting the NAG, underwater medicine for the medical support for the hyperbaric chamber of the NAVSOG, and surface warfare medicine for the floating assets of the PN which is not present to date. Going beyond sickbay medicine, surface warfare medicine must entail developing the capability of the Navy Corpsman to provide medical care alone or in synchrony with a medical professional aboard

ship. Considering the shipboard sickbay is an austere environment, surface warfare medicine is but like Marine Corps operational medicine but in an afloat environment, devoid of immediate support from nearby higher echelons of medical care. The proposed conceptual framework for the Naval Medical Service is as shown:



From the above diagram, it is evident of the diverse breadth and scope that Navy Medicine covers. It is best to divide the organization in terms of main terrain. The PN in itself is organized along the lines of the type commands (the Marines and the Fleet) which operate ashore and afloat with an interface in amphibious operations. Thus





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addressing medical doctrine along those lines would be a feasible approach. Ashore medicine would be further subdivided to hospital medicine and operational medicine, both aspects that are currently in practice in other AFP branches of service. Hospital medicine can also play a significant role in service support operations, military operations other than war (MOOTW), humanitarian assistance and disaster relief (HA/DR) operations. Afloat medicine also complements the breadth of operations of the major forces of the Fleet. Underwater medicine currently is practiced by the Naval Special Operations forces, which can be a template of medical operations for future plans of the PN to have its own Silent Service. Integration of operational medicine in the form of tactical medicine practiced by the PMC to complement the underwater medicine in the NAVSOG in both doctrine and training can further enhance survivability of NAVSOG personnel in their missions. Surface Warfare Medicine, a branch of Navy Medicine is meant to address medical department operations aboard floating assets of the Navy which are a peculiar operating environment specific for the Navy. The influx of new ships from the Weather High Endurance Cutters to the programmed Multi Role Vessels points further in the direction of resurrecting and improving this aspect of Navy Medicine. Aviation medicine, a highly specialized form of medicine is already an established medical branch in the Navy through air evacuation operations performed by the Naval Air

Group that again is geared to be enhanced with rotary assets planned to complement the future floating assets of the Fleet.

After defining this conceptual framework, it would be appropriate to follow the Defense System of Management (DSOM) in order to align the proposed framework to the management methodology prescribed by higher headquarters. Using the DOTMLPF approach, it is quite evident that majority of the factors to consider in analyzing Navy Medicine's effectivity is wanting. Doctrine, the core guide on how the organization is to be run, is one area that needs attention. A late 1970's US military doctrine that is mostly forgotten is what is existent, thus a pressing need to create one that will involve the proposed conceptual framework. Another vital concern that needs attention is the personnel and leadership aspect, for the health care professionals needed to lead, and deliver health service, the medical officers are very few in number and hardly enough to provide appropriate medical cover to its clientele. The enlisted side of the house, especially for the Fleet side also needs attention in terms of career management and enhanced training. Training, a significant aspect of DOTMLPF that ensures the continuity of knowledge, is one aspect that can be tapped to support the doctrinal change. In the Philippine Marine Corps, medical training in exercises involving PMC forces like PHIBLEX and BALIKATAN have increased in emphasis on training and developing medical force multipliers to augment its limited medical personnel through Combat Life Saver (CLS) Training. More realistic and responsive training of more useful combat skills which include the use of the SimMan of the USMC, has already started; the shift in medical

training of the PMC goes forward from the traditional first aid/BLS training that was SOP years ago to critical medical skills for its Corpsmen. It is in this light that medical planning for exercises on the Fleet side would also be geared to addressing the development of a more robust Fleet Medical capability. Subject Matter Exchanges (SMEE) have been initiated this CARAT 2012 wherein PN Medical Service personnel are to have a symposium geared towards the introduction of Operational Medicine. Simply said, the road to improving Navy Medicine in order for it to be able to address its mandated job effectively and adequately has already begun

It is thus apparent that Navy Medicine encompasses the full spectrum of operations be it land, sea or air and is supposed to support both forward and rear of its forces, making it a unique medical service within the AFP. With adequate planning for future activities, specifically exercises, the arms and legs of the proposed doctrine shall have substance, thus strengthening the validity and significance of such. This article is meant to open the eyes of those who are in a position to elicit change with the proposed framework as the centerpiece of the discussion. Hopefully by the time the PN goals in its Sail Plan have been met, so has Naval Medicine progressed to be an effective partner in accomplishing the mission of the PN.



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